MSEP Area 2025 Data Summaries

Mississippi Sound Estuary Program

November 13, 2026

Table of contents

Introduction 6

I Weather and Climate-related variables 7

1 Precipitation 8
1.1 Overall Summary . . . 8
1.2 Supporting Information . . . 8
1.2.1 Annual Precipitation, Averaged to HUC8 . . . 8
1.2.2 Monthly Precipitation . . . 13
1.2.3 Tropical Events . . . 17
1.2.4 Drought Index . . . 17
1.2.5 El Nino . . . 17
About . . . 17

2 Freshwater Inflows 18
2.1 Overall Summary . . . 18
2.2 Supporting Information . . . 18
2.2.1 Rivers . . . 18
2.2.2 Mobile Bay . . . 18
2.2.3 Bonnet Carre . . . 18
About . . . 19

II People and Land Use 20

3 Population 21
3.1 Overall Summary . . . 21
3.2 Supporting Information . . . 21
3.2.1 Regional / Watershed Population . . . 21
3.2.2 Broken down by Subbasin (HUC8) . . . 22
3.2.3 Maps of pop and change by subbasin . . . 22
About . . . 23

4 Land Use / Land Cover 24
4.1 Overall Summary . . . 24

4.2 Supporting Information . . . 24
4.2.1 Entire Watershed . . . 24
4.2.2 By Basin . . . 25
About . . . 25

III Water Conditions **26**

5 Salinity **27**
5.1 Overall Summary . . . 27
5.2 Supporting Information . . . 27
5.2.1 Deployed Sensors . . . 27
5.2.2 DMR fisheries and shrimp sampling . . . 27
5.2.3 Mississippi Coastal Assessment . . . 27
5.2.4 Other salinity data in the area . . . 27
About . . . 27

6 Dissolved Oxygen **28**
6.1 Overall Summary . . . 28
6.2 Supporting Information . . . 28
6.2.1 DEQ data . . . 28
6.2.2 Deployed Sensors . . . 28
6.2.3 DMR fisheries and shrimp sampling . . . 28
6.2.4 Mississippi Coastal Assessment . . . 28
6.2.5 Other salinity data in the area . . . 28
About . . . 28

7 Turbidity / Suspended Solids **30**
7.1 Overall Summary . . . 30
7.2 Supporting Information . . . 30
7.2.1 Turbidity - Deployed Sensors . . . 30
7.2.2 TSS - DEQ Beach Sampling . . . 30
7.2.3 TSS - Mississippi Coastal Assessment . . . 30
7.2.4 Other data in the area . . . 30
About . . . 30

8 Nutrients **31**
8.1 Overall Summary . . . 31
8.2 Supporting Information . . . 31
8.2.1 DEQ Beach Sampling . . . 31
8.2.2 DEQ Freshwater Programs . . . 31
8.2.3 Mississippi Coastal Assessment . . . 31
8.2.4 Other data in the area . . . 31

About . . . 31

9 Chlorophyll *a* 32
9.1 Overall Summary . . . 32
9.2 Supporting Information . . . 32
9.2.1 DEQ Beach Sampling . . . 32
9.2.2 DEQ Freshwater Programs . . . 32
9.2.3 Mississippi Coastal Assessment . . . 32
9.2.4 Other data in the area . . . 32
About . . . 32

IV Pollutants/Contaminants 33

10 Beach Advisories 34
10.1 Overall Summary . . . 34
10.2 Supporting Information . . . 34
10.2.1 DEQ Beach Sampling . . . 34
About . . . 35

11 Shellfish Closures 36
11.1 Overall Summary . . . 36
11.2 Supporting Information . . . 36
11.2.1 DMR . . . 36
About . . . 36

12 Impaired Waterbodies 37
12.1 Overall Summary . . . 37
12.2 Supporting Information . . . 37
12.2.1 DEQ Info . . . 37
About . . . 37

Appendices 38

A Data Processing 38
A.1 Weather and Climate-related variables . . . 38
A.1.1 Precipitation . . . 38
A.1.2 Freshwater Inflows . . . 38
A.2 People and Land Use . . . 38
A.2.1 Population . . . 38
A.2.2 Land Use / Land Cover . . . 38
A.3 Water Conditions . . . 38
A.3.1 Salinity . . . 38

A.3.2 Dissolved Oxygen 39
A.3.3 Turbidity / Suspended Solids 39
A.3.4 Nutrients 39
A.3.5 Chlorophyll *a* 39
A.4 Pollutants/Contaminants 39
A.4.1 Beach Advisories 39
A.4.2 Shellfish Closures 39
A.4.3 Impaired Waterbodies 39
About 39

Introduction

This website is a collection of documents summarizing the condition of the Mississippi Sound and its watershed in 2025, as compared to "baseline" conditions (which we also need to define, at appropriate spatial scales for each parameter). This will be the technical supporting information for what ultimately goes into a State of the Sound report. The State of the Sound will be public-facing, whereas the intended audience for this document is largely technical.

The outputs are compiled as a 'quarto book'. Each chapter is produced by a separate `.qmd` file.

The purpose of the book format is to make the outputs readily findable and accessible. It also serves as an outline for future undertakings like a complete baseline characterization of these parameters and future State of the Sound reports.

You can download a pdf version of this entire book by clicking on the pdf icon on the right side of the toolbar at the top of this page.

Part I

Weather and Climate-related variables

1 Precipitation

1.1 Overall Summary

2025 was normal-to-dry across the Mississippi Sound Watershed. In terms of the annual total precipitation received, about 1/3 of the subbasins were within 5% of the 30-year average total. The others ranged about 10-20% lower for their annual totals. The subbasins that were driest were generally in the southern portions of the watershed, whereas the more northern subbasins were closer to the long-term average. See Figure 1.1 and Figure 1.3 in particular for details.

In terms of monthly totals, May was a little bit wet, particularly in the middle portion of the watershed, and the dry months were September and November. See Figure 1.7.

For a summary table of annual and monthly totals, normals, and % difference from normal, see Table 1.1.

1.2 Supporting Information

1.2.1 Annual Precipitation, Averaged to HUC8

Annual totals were calculated from monthly precipitation data obtained from the PRISM Group at Oregon State University, https://prism.oregonstate.edu which were accessed 29 July 2026.

1.2.1.1 Maps

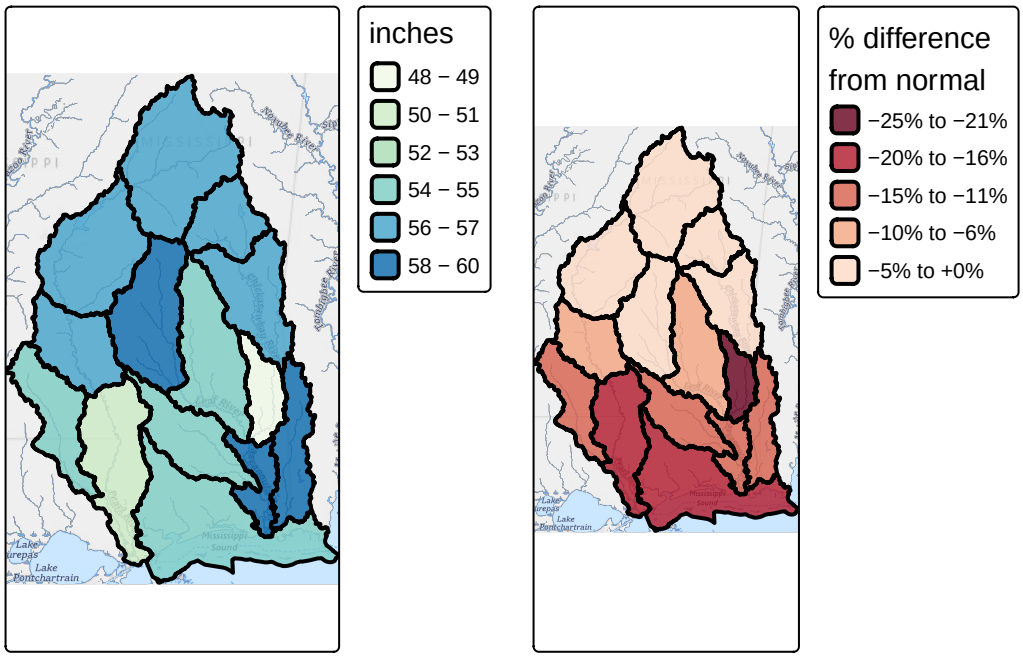


Figure 1.1: Maps of 2025 precipitation, averaged to the HUC8 level. Left: Total precipitation, inches. Right: Difference from normal precipitation, as a percent (e.g. -5% means precipitation was 5% lower than normal). Darker colors indicate values further from the long-term average (blue = more precipitation than normal; red = less).

1.2.1.2 Time Series Graphs

In the HTML version of this document, the following time series graphs are interactive. Hovering over a line shows which subbasin it represents, and hovering over a point shows more information about the yearly total.

1.2.1.2.1 Total Precipitation

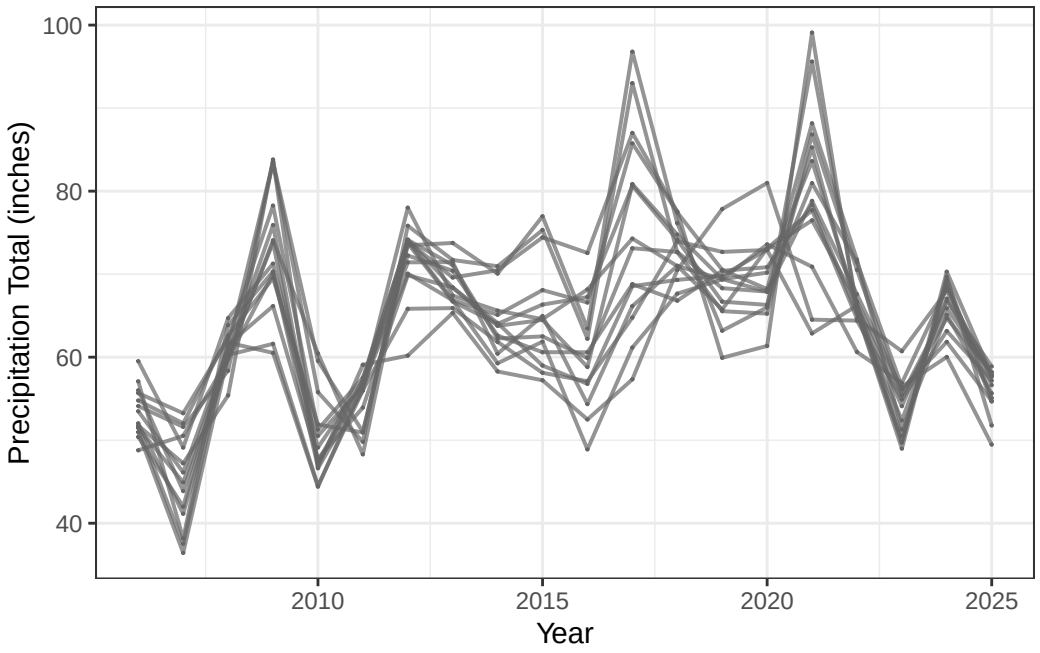


Figure 1.2: Time series of annual precipitation total (inches) by HUC-8 (subbasin). Each line represents a subbasin.

1.2.1.2.2 Precip difference from normal, as a percent

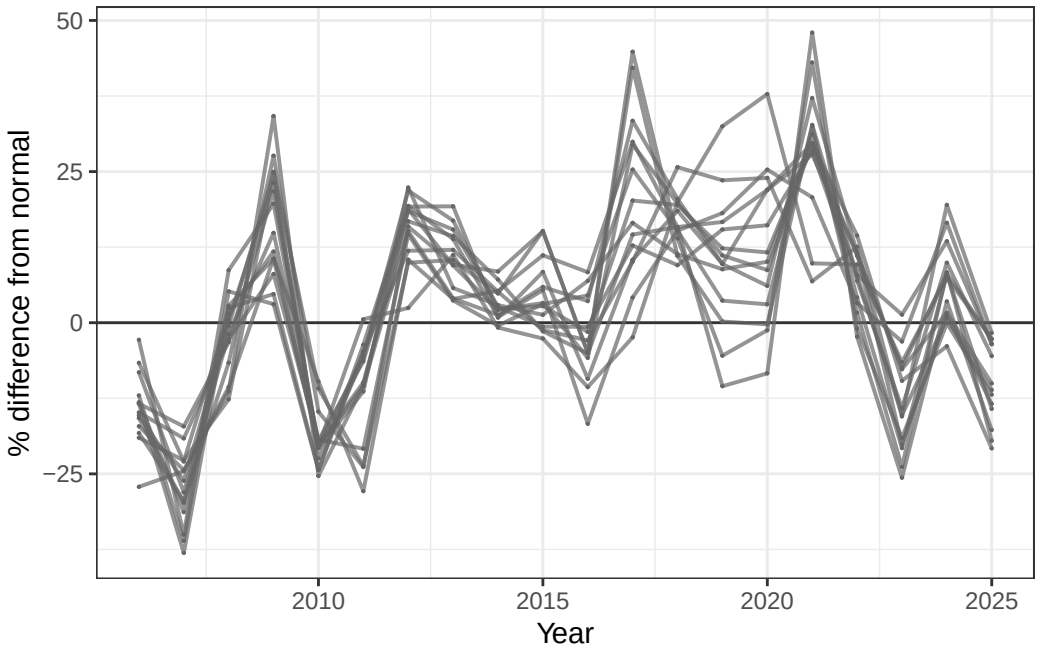


Figure 1.3: Time series of differences from 30-year average precipitation, by HUC-8 (subbasin). Each line represents a subbasin.

1.2.1.2.3 Boxplot time series

Each box represents a single year; overlaid points represent subbasins.

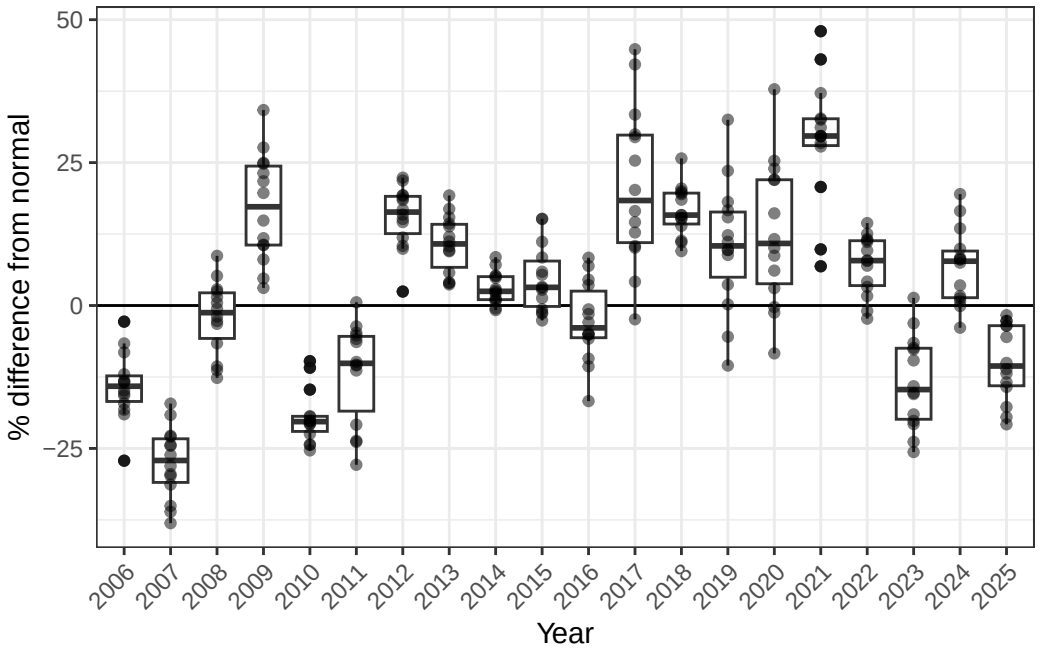


Figure 1.4: Boxplot representing the distribution of rainfall totals by subbasin by year. Each box represents a year; each overlaid point represents a subbasin. Whiskers extend to the quantiles +/- 1.5 times the IQR.

Here is the same plot, but with points identifiable to subbasin.

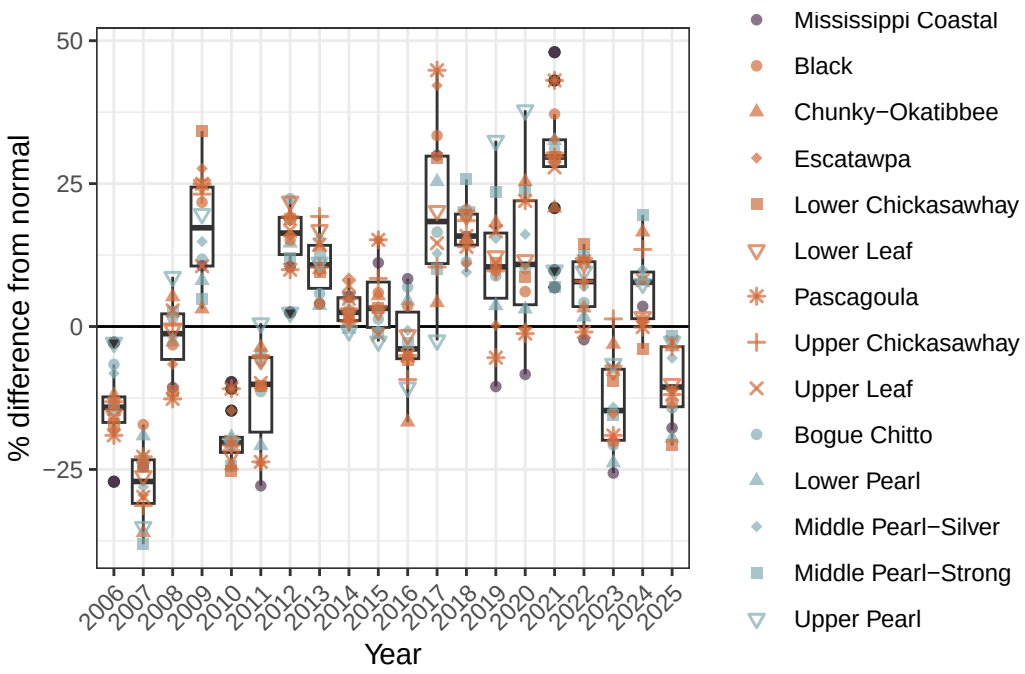


Figure 1.5: Boxplot representing the distribution of rainfall totals by subbasin by year. Each box represents a year; each overlaid point represents a subbasin. Each color represents a basin, with shapes within colors representing the subbasins. Whiskers extend to the quantiles +/- 1.5 times the IQR.

1.2.2 Monthly Precipitation

Monthly data are from the PRISM Group at Oregon State University, https://prism.oregonstate.edu and were accessed 29 July 2026. They are again averaged to HUC8. Monthly normals are also from the PRISM group, and were compiled in the `msepBaselineData` R package.

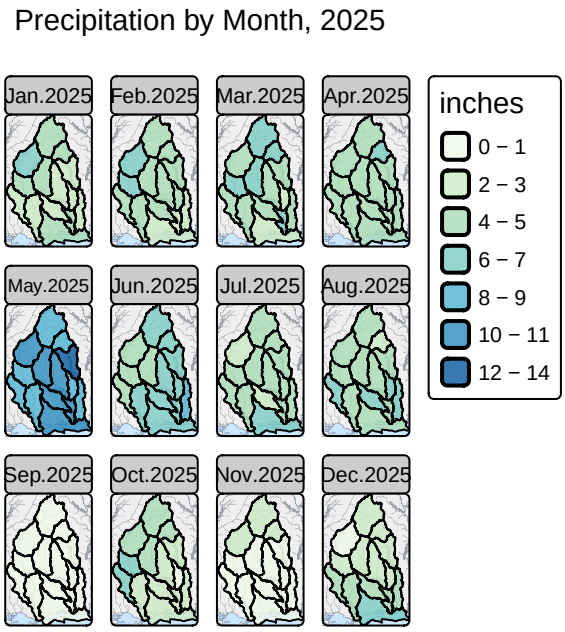


Figure 1.6: Map of monthly precipitation totals (inches), averaged to the HUC-8 (subbasin) level.

1.2.2.1 Monthly Anomalies

From long-term climate normals, as provided by the PRISM Climate Group at Oregon State University and processed into the `msepBaselineData` package's `precip_normals_huc8avg` dataset.

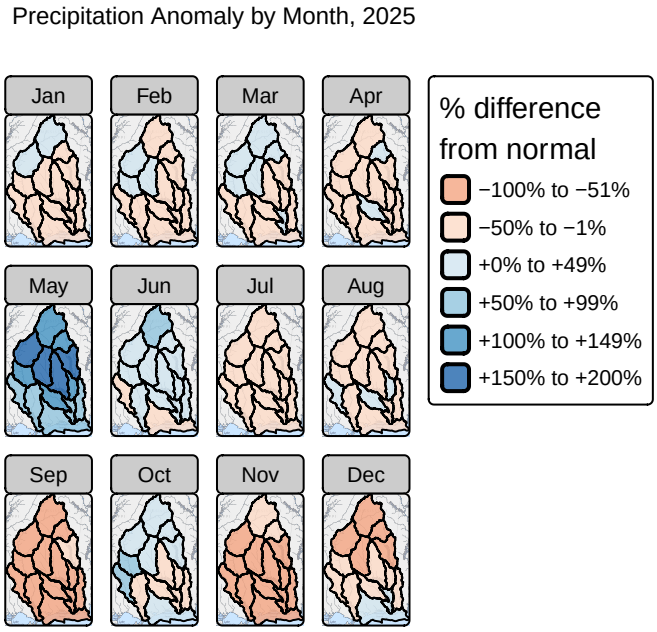


Figure 1.7: Map of monthly precipitation difference from normal, as a percent (i.e. '-10' can be read as '10% below normal'), averaged to the HUC-8 (subbasin) level.

1.2.2.2 Table of Anomalies

Table 1.1: Precipitation totals and anomalies by HUC-8 for all months and the annual total of 2025 (inches). Top value in each cell is the 2025 total; bottom values are the 30-year normal followed by the percent difference from normal in parentheses. In the interactive table, clicking a month or Annual column header sorts by percent difference from normal. Cells are colored by percent difference from normal; wetter in blue and drier in red, and larger values are darker colors.

Basin	HUC8	Subbasin	Annual	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Coastal Streams	03170009	Mississippi Coastal	55.1 67.0 (-17.7%)	4.4 5.7 (-23.0%)	3.8 4.6 (-15.9%)	3.8 5.4 (-28.9%)	4.0 5.5 (-27.3%)	10.1 5.4 (+88.0%)	6.4 6.8 (-5.2%)	6.1 7.8 (-21.2%)	4.6 6.9 (-33.3%)	1.0 5.7 (-82.9%)	4.0 3.9 (+1.5%)	0.5 4.2 (-88.1%)	6.3 5.1 (+24.9%)
Pascagoula River	03170001	Chunky-Okatibbee	56.5 58.7 (-3.7%)	5.5 5.7 (-3.3%)	4.2 5.5 (-24.5%)	6.8 5.7 (+20.1%)	6.1 5.9 (+3.1%)	9.3 4.2 (+121.4%)	6.4 4.7 (+36.5%)	4.0 5.2 (-23.8%)	4.0 4.7 (-15.2%)	0.8 3.4 (-77.5%)	4.7 3.8 (+23.4%)	2.7 4.4 (-38.7%)	2.0 5.4 (-62.4%)
Pascagoula River	03170002	Upper Chickasawhay	57.7 59.9 (-3.7%)	3.9 5.8 (-32.5%)	5.1 5.4 (-5.5%)	6.0 6.0 (-0.1%)	4.9 5.2 (-6.0%)	12.1 4.2 (+186.1%)	6.6 5.2 (+27.2%)	5.2 5.6 (-6.9%)	4.3 5.1 (-15.6%)	1.9 3.7 (-48.3%)	3.9 3.7 (+6.2%)	1.3 4.3 (-69.5%)	2.3 5.6 (-58.9%)
Pascagoula River	03170003	Lower Chickasawhay	49.5 62.5 (-20.8%)	3.1 6.1 (-48.8%)	4.6 5.1 (-11.3%)	3.5 5.8 (-40.5%)	4.1 4.9 (-17.4%)	9.5 4.7 (+103.6%)	6.3 5.8 (+7.1%)	4.1 6.2 (-34.4%)	6.2 5.5 (+13.9%)	1.5 4.3 (-66.6%)	2.0 3.7 (-46.9%)	1.1 4.3 (-74.1%)	3.6 5.8 (-38.8%)
Pascagoula River	03170004	Upper Leaf	58.2 59.8 (-2.7%)	4.4 5.8 (-23.9%)	5.6 5.4 (+3.6%)	6.1 5.8 (+4.9%)	4.9 5.6 (-11.2%)	12.0 4.3 (+181.6%)	5.9 4.9 (+20.6%)	4.5 5.5 (-18.0%)	4.4 5.2 (-14.9%)	1.2 3.8 (-69.4%)	5.1 3.6 (+42.6%)	1.3 4.4 (-70.3%)	2.7 5.6 (-50.8%)
Pascagoula River	03170005	Lower Leaf	54.8 60.8 (-9.9%)	3.5 6.0 (-42.0%)	5.0 5.3 (-6.5%)	4.6 5.9 (-22.5%)	5.2 5.3 (-0.7%)	11.2 4.5 (+150.8%)	6.2 5.3 (+16.3%)	5.0 5.9 (-14.8%)	4.9 5.2 (-4.9%)	1.3 4.0 (-67.1%)	3.6 3.6 (-0.4%)	1.1 4.2 (-72.8%)	3.1 5.6 (-44.4%)
Pascagoula River	03170006	Pascagoula	58.9 66.8 (-11.9%)	4.7 5.9 (-20.7%)	4.0 4.6 (-14.6%)	6.1 5.5 (+10.0%)	4.6 5.3 (-14.2%)	10.6 5.4 (+97.4%)	7.6 6.6 (+14.2%)	5.2 7.6 (-31.6%)	5.2 6.7 (-21.7%)	0.7 5.3 (-86.2%)	3.5 4.0 (-13.0%)	0.9 4.3 (-78.4%)	5.9 5.5 (+6.9%)
Pascagoula River	03170007	Black	55.7 64.3 (-13.4%)	3.5 6.0 (-41.7%)	4.8 5.1 (-6.3%)	4.2 5.7 (-26.7%)	5.4 5.3 (+2.7%)	10.9 5.1 (+113.6%)	7.1 6.0 (+17.5%)	3.9 6.8 (-42.3%)	6.0 5.9 (+1.7%)	1.0 4.7 (-79.0%)	3.0 3.8 (-21.6%)	1.6 4.2 (-61.9%)	4.3 5.7 (-24.1%)
Pascagoula River	03170008	Escatawpa	58.1 65.4 (-11.2%)	3.9 5.9 (-33.3%)	3.9 4.8 (-17.7%)	4.8 5.4 (-11.7%)	5.1 5.1 (-0.8%)	9.9 5.1 (+94.3%)	8.4 6.4 (+31.4%)	5.8 7.2 (-19.7%)	6.1 6.5 (-5.2%)	0.8 5.1 (-83.8%)	3.0 4.0 (-25.3%)	0.9 4.4 (-78.6%)	5.4 5.6 (-3.2%)
Pearl River	03180001	Upper Pearl	57.2 58.8 (-2.6%)	5.8 5.5 (+5.6%)	4.6 5.7 (-19.6%)	6.2 5.5 (+12.4%)	5.5 6.1 (-8.9%)	8.8 4.4 (+100.1%)	6.8 4.2 (+60.7%)	4.1 5.1 (-19.4%)	4.5 4.6 (-3.5%)	1.3 3.7 (-64.7%)	4.5 3.9 (+16.6%)	2.9 4.5 (-36.5%)	2.1 5.4 (-61.5%)
Pearl River	03180002	Middle Pearl-Strong	57.9 58.8 (-1.6%)	6.2 5.7 (+8.9%)	6.0 5.6 (+8.7%)	5.8 5.6 (+2.8%)	5.1 6.0 (-14.0%)	10.7 4.2 (+154.5%)	5.8 4.5 (+29.6%)	3.8 5.1 (-24.5%)	4.2 4.8 (-11.8%)	1.5 3.7 (-60.7%)	4.6 3.7 (+26.0%)	2.2 4.7 (-52.3%)	1.8 5.4 (-65.7%)
Pearl River	03180003	Middle Pearl-Silver	57.7 61.0 (-5.4%)	4.2 6.0 (-30.7%)	6.0 5.7 (+5.2%)	6.3 5.7 (+9.9%)	5.0 5.5 (-8.0%)	9.3 4.4 (+109.3%)	5.4 5.0 (+6.9%)	4.2 5.6 (-25.3%)	4.8 5.3 (-8.9%)	1.6 4.0 (-60.5%)	6.7 3.8 (+75.9%)	1.1 4.4 (-75.9%)	3.2 5.5 (-42.1%)
Pearl River	03180004	Lower Pearl	51.7 64.3 (-19.7%)	3.3 5.9 (-43.8%)	4.3 5.0 (-14.5%)	4.1 5.5 (-25.1%)	4.8 5.3 (-9.7%)	8.8 5.1 (+71.1%)	6.3 6.3 (+1.3%)	5.0 6.7 (-26.5%)	4.7 6.3 (-24.8%)	0.7 4.6 (-84.6%)	3.8 4.1 (-6.8%)	1.2 4.1 (-71.4%)	4.6 5.3 (-13.9%)
Pearl River	03180005	Bogue Chitto	54.8 63.7 (-14.0%)	3.3 6.2 (-45.8%)	4.4 5.5 (-20.1%)	5.4 5.7 (-5.3%)	5.0 5.3 (-5.4%)	8.4 5.0 (+67.6%)	4.8 5.7 (-15.7%)	4.2 6.2 (-32.1%)	6.2 6.0 (+4.4%)	1.2 4.3 (-73.1%)	6.5 4.2 (+55.4%)	1.1 4.2 (-72.4%)	4.2 5.5 (-23.5%)

1.2.3 Tropical Events

1.2.4 Drought Index

1.2.5 El Nino

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **precipitation.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here*.

2 Freshwater Inflows

2.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "River inputs were about average this year", or "Pearl River inputs were higher than normal, while Pascagoula River inputs were lower than normal", or "Flows from both main rivers were higher than normal this year, and the Bonnet Carre spillway was open for a substantial amount of time, causing XYZ impacts".

2.2 Supporting Information

2.2.1 Rivers

Pearl and Pascagoula River USGS gauges

2.2.2 Mobile Bay

?? certainly affects the Eastern Sound, even if exact amount is in question (estimates vary; I have some references if we want to talk about this) so probably worth noting.

2.2.3 Bonnet Carre

- number of openings
- number of days open
- Volume released

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **freshwater_inflows.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here*.

Part II

People and Land Use

3 Population

3.1 Overall Summary

About 1.5 million Mississippians, half of the state's population of 3 million, lived within the Mississippi Sound Watershed in 2020. The total population of the Mississippi Sound Watershed, which includes portions of Alabama and Louisiana, in 2020 was about 1.7 million. See Table 3.1 for the breakdown.

Population in the Mississippi Sound Watershed as a whole, within the MSEP Study Area (the portion of the MS Sound Watershed contained only within the state of Mississippi), and in the state of Mississippi itself was generally stable between 2010 and 2020 (see Table 3.1). Within the larger area, however, some subbasins had increases or decreases of up to 9% (see Table 3.2).

3.2 Supporting Information

The EPA's EnviroAtlas provides gridded estimates of decadal US Census data for the years 2010 and 2020. These data were summarized for the region in the `{msepBaselineData}` R package and are presented here.

3.2.1 Regional / Watershed Population

Table 3.1: Population, in millions, of relevant areas, from decadal US Census values. The MSEP study area is the portion of the Mississippi Sound Watershed contained in the state of Mississippi. Percent change was calculated before rounding.

Area	2010	2020	Percent Change
Entire Mississippi Sound Watershed	1.70	1.72	+1.1%
MSEP Study Area	1.53	1.54	+0.8%
State of MS	2.97	2.96	-0.2%

3.2.2 Broken down by Subbasin (HUC8)

In the html version of this document, this table is sortable by clicking on a column name.

Table 3.2: Population, rounded to the nearest thousand, of the Mississippi Sound Watershed by subbasin (HUC8) from decadal US Census values. Percent change was calculated before rounding. Numbers may not add up to exactly the values for the Entire Mississippi Sound Watershed due partially to rounding and partially to how grid cells along HUC8 boundaries were handled.

Basin	Subbasin	HUC8 ID	2010	2020	Percent Change
Coastal Streams	Mississippi Coastal	03170009	339,000	369,000	+8.9%
Pascagoula River	Chunky-Okatibbee	03170001	85,000	78,000	-8.3%
Pascagoula River	Upper Chickasawhay	03170002	43,000	40,000	-5.6%
Pascagoula River	Lower Chickasawhay	03170003	14,000	14,000	-2.0%
Pascagoula River	Upper Leaf	03170004	99,000	99,000	+0.9%
Pascagoula River	Lower Leaf	03170005	135,000	135,000	-0.3%
Pascagoula River	Pascagoula	03170006	54,000	54,000	-0.4%
Pascagoula River	Black	03170007	59,000	64,000	+8.5%
Pascagoula River	Escatawpa	03170008	101,000	107,000	+6.0%
Pearl River	Upper Pearl	03180001	109,000	103,000	-5.7%
Pearl River	Middle Pearl-Strong	03180002	406,000	405,000	-0.2%
Pearl River	Middle Pearl-Silver	03180003	41,000	38,000	-6.6%
Pearl River	Lower Pearl	03180004	140,000	136,000	-2.5%
Pearl River	Bogue Chitto	03180005	74,000	74,000	-1.0%

3.2.3 Maps of pop and change by subbasin

Population densities are calculated based on land area in each subbasin (i.e. the area of the Mississippi Sound is not included in calculations for the Coastal Streams Basin).

For file size purposes, the precision of the outlines in these maps has been reduced. That reduction was performed after calculating densities and change.

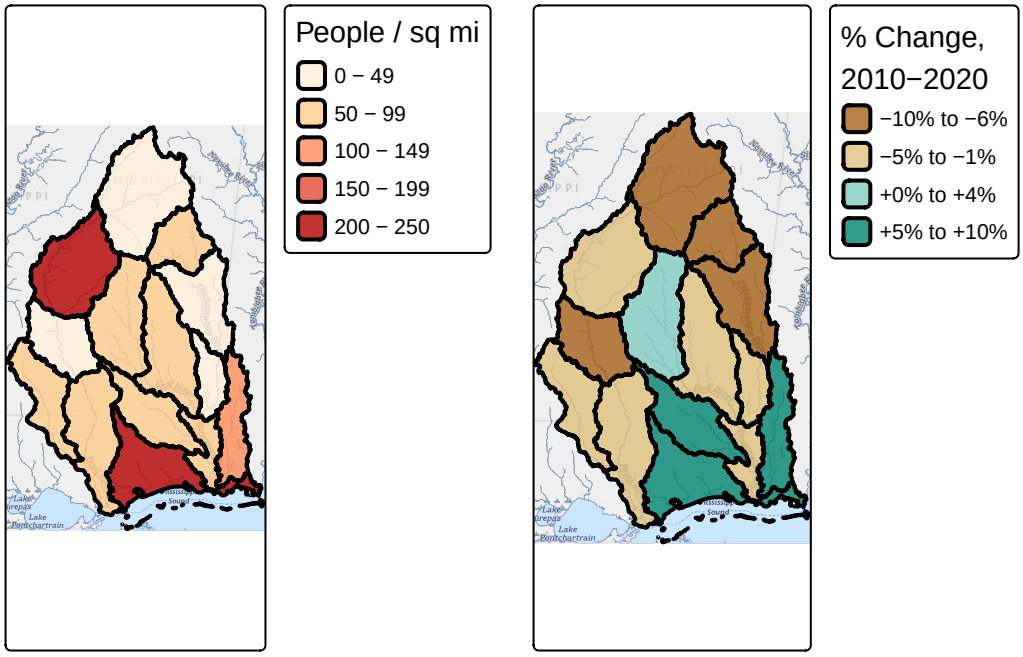


Figure 3.1: Maps of Population: Density (people per square mile; left), and Change between 2010 and 2020 (right). Color scales are automatic based on data so while darker colors on the right map do represent larger changes than others in the dataset, they still may be relatively small.

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **population.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here*.

4 Land Use / Land Cover

4.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "The coastal counties of the watershed have become more developed in the last 10 years, while developed landcover in the more inland counties has remained relatively stable"

4.2 Supporting Information

Data for this section comes from the National Land Cover Dataset, Collection 1.2, as processed into the `{msepBaselineData}` R package.

4.2.1 Entire Watershed

Table 4.1: Percent land cover across the entire Mississippi Sound Watershed by year and broad land cover category.

Category	2005	2010	2015	2020	2025
Open Water	6.4%	6.4%	6.4%	6.4%	6.4%
Developed	8.4%	8.7%	8.9%	9.0%	9.3%
Barren	0.3%	0.3%	0.3%	0.3%	0.4%
Forest	38.2%	38.0%	39.1%	38.9%	39.1%
Shrub/Grassland	8.9%	9.5%	8.6%	8.8%	8.6%
Agriculture	15.4%	14.8%	14.5%	14.3%	14.2%
Wetlands	22.5%	22.3%	22.2%	22.1%	22.0%

4.2.2 By Basin

Table 4.2: Percent land cover by basin, year, and broad land cover category. In the html version, click on a Basin to expand it to the categories.

Basin	Category	2005	2010	2015	2020	2025
Coastal Streams	Open Water	40.2%	40.2%	40.2%	40.2%	40.2%
Coastal Streams	Developed	8.9%	9.6%	9.8%	10.0%	10.3%
Coastal Streams	Barren	0.6%	0.7%	0.7%	0.7%	0.8%
Coastal Streams	Forest	18.2%	16.7%	18.2%	18.9%	18.8%
Coastal Streams	Shrub/Grassland	5.0%	6.0%	4.4%	3.4%	3.3%
Coastal Streams	Agriculture	5.9%	5.8%	5.9%	5.8%	5.8%
Coastal Streams	Wetlands	21.1%	21.0%	20.9%	20.9%	20.8%
Pascagoula	Open Water	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%	1.0%
Pascagoula	Developed	7.8%	8.1%	8.3%	8.4%	8.7%
Pascagoula	Barren	0.2%	0.2%	0.2%	0.2%	0.3%
Pascagoula	Forest	42.8%	42.8%	43.9%	43.8%	43.7%
Pascagoula	Shrub/Grassland	10.2%	10.5%	9.5%	9.6%	9.6%
Pascagoula	Agriculture	14.1%	13.7%	13.5%	13.4%	13.3%
Pascagoula	Wetlands	23.8%	23.7%	23.6%	23.5%	23.4%
Pearl	Open Water	1.3%	1.3%	1.4%	1.4%	1.3%
Pearl	Developed	8.8%	9.1%	9.2%	9.4%	9.6%
Pearl	Barren	0.3%	0.3%	0.3%	0.3%	0.4%
Pearl	Forest	39.7%	39.5%	40.5%	40.0%	40.5%
Pearl	Shrub/Grassland	8.7%	9.5%	9.0%	9.7%	9.3%
Pearl	Agriculture	19.8%	19.0%	18.4%	18.1%	17.8%
Pearl	Wetlands	21.4%	21.3%	21.1%	21.0%	20.9%

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **landuse_landcover.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here.*

Part III

Water Conditions

5 Salinity

5.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "Salinity was lower than normal, and this was more pronounced in the Eastern Sound than the rest of the area." Tie back to Chapter 1 and Chapter 2 chapters.

5.2 Supporting Information

5.2.1 Deployed Sensors

USGS/DMR hydrological stations, DMR sensor network, USM-GCRL stations (in the future), Grand Bay NERR SWMP stations

5.2.2 DMR fisheries and shrimp sampling

5.2.3 Mississippi Coastal Assessment

5.2.4 Other salinity data in the area

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **salinity.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here*.

6 Dissolved Oxygen

6.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "Hypoxia was more (or less) prevalent than usual in the eastern Sound and its bays, and about normal elsewhere along the coast. In freshwater streams and rivers, hypoxia was about normal."

6.2 Supporting Information

6.2.1 DEQ data

Inland sampling network programs

6.2.2 Deployed Sensors

USGS/DMR hydrological stations, DMR sensor network, USM-GCRL stations (in the future), Grand Bay NERR SWMP stations

6.2.3 DMR fisheries and shrimp sampling

6.2.4 Mississippi Coastal Assessment

6.2.5 Other salinity data in the area

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **dissolved_oxygen.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here*.

7 Turbidity / Suspended Solids

7.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "Turbidity was lower than normal (clearer water!) in the rivers and streams, while Total Suspended Solids were higher than normal across the Sound."

7.2 Supporting Information

7.2.1 Turbidity - Deployed Sensors

DMR sensor network, USM-GCRL stations (in the future), Grand Bay NERR SWMP stations

7.2.2 TSS - DEQ Beach Sampling

7.2.3 TSS - Mississippi Coastal Assessment

7.2.4 Other data in the area

Grand Bay SWMP has been doing TSS since ~2021

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **turb_tss.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here.*

8 Nutrients

May want to split this into N and P; there are different species of each and that might be a lot for one chapter.

8.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "Nitrogen and phosphorus concentrations were higher than normal, and this was more pronounced in the Eastern Sound than the rest of the area. This coincides with extreme Bonnet Carre inputs."

8.2 Supporting Information

8.2.1 DEQ Beach Sampling

8.2.2 DEQ Freshwater Programs

8.2.3 Mississippi Coastal Assessment

8.2.4 Other data in the area

Grand Bay SWMP

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **nutrients.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here.*

9 Chlorophyll *a*

Make sure to note whether programs are using "chl corrected for phaeophytin" or "not corrected for phaeophytin".

9.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "Chlorophyll was about normal across coastal waterbodies this year."

9.2 Supporting Information

9.2.1 DEQ Beach Sampling

9.2.2 DEQ Freshwater Programs

9.2.3 Mississippi Coastal Assessment

uses uncorrected chl

9.2.4 Other data in the area

Grand Bay SWMP; uses corrected chl

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **chla.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here*.

Part IV

Pollutants/Contaminants

10 Beach Advisories

This section will be based on data from beaches.mdeq.ms.gov.

10.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "Overall, the number of beach advisory days was lower than normal, and at *example hot spot stations* in particular, the number has been decreasing."

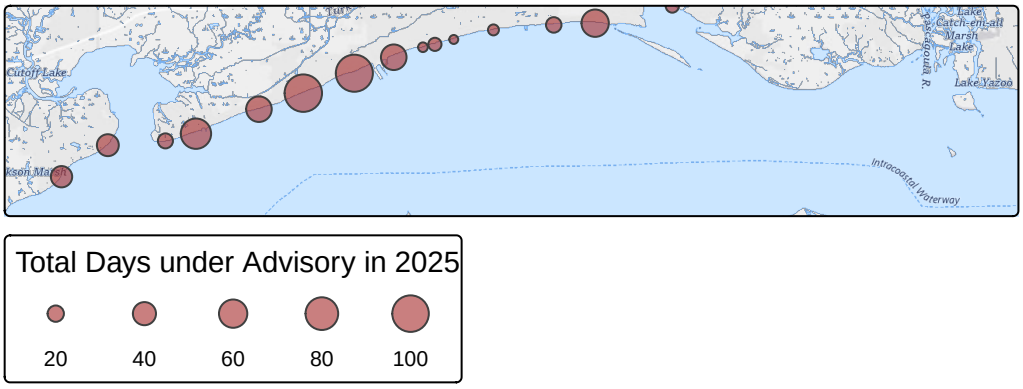
10.2 Supporting Information

10.2.1 DEQ Beach Sampling

Make a map where each station is represented by a point, and the point size is based on the number of days that station was under advisory in the year.

no. of beach closure days by station (see PPBEP's online map)

- Can download advisory/closure info from DEQ: https://beaches.mdeq.ms.gov/Historical/HCA
- Per station, calculate # advisories/closures, # days under advisory/closure (total), mean or median # days per advisory/closure
- Aggregate across coast: how many days under advisory/closure across all stations (sum of station totals); break down whether it's just a few troublesome sites (seems to be based on presentations I've seen from DEQ) and what % of advisory/closure days came from those few sites



About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **beach_advisories.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here*.

11 Shellfish Closures

This section will be based on data from MDMR.

11.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

e.g. "Shellfish beds were closed less than normal this year."

11.2 Supporting Information

11.2.1 DMR

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **shellfish_closures.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here.*

12 Impaired Waterbodies

This section will be based on DEQ's 303d list.

12.1 Overall Summary

Note: These summaries are NOT factual. They are examples of how we might want to talk about what we find, to help ensure we do calculations in the right way. I am completely making up details and could be very, very wrong. Please do not treat this information as factual.

Here just the number of miles (rivers/streams) or acres (lakes, estuaries) that are listed as impaired. Was this more or less than the last State of the Sound report?

12.2 Supporting Information

12.2.1 DEQ Info

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **impaired_waterbodies.qmd**.

For information on data sources and processing, see *appendix cross-reference here.*

A Data Processing

In general, links to original data sources are provided in each section below. Because data files are routinely updated, the files as downloaded and used in this document are also available online. These files are provided for reproducibility and transparency; for your own analyses, we encourage you to seek out data from the original linked sources.

A.1 Weather and Climate-related variables

A.1.1 Precipitation

Go back to Chapter 1

A.1.2 Freshwater Inflows

Go back to Chapter 2

A.2 People and Land Use

A.2.1 Population

Go back to Chapter 3

A.2.2 Land Use / Land Cover

Go back to Chapter 4

A.3 Water Conditions

A.3.1 Salinity

Go back to Chapter 5

A.3.2 Dissolved Oxygen

Go back to Chapter 6

A.3.3 Turbidity / Suspended Solids

Go back to Chapter 7

A.3.4 Nutrients

Go back to Chapter 8

A.3.5 Chlorophyll *a*

Go back to Chapter 9

A.4 Pollutants/Contaminants

A.4.1 Beach Advisories

Go back to Chapter 10

A.4.2 Shellfish Closures

Go back to Chapter 11

A.4.3 Impaired Waterbodies

Go back to Chapter 12

About

The `.qmd` file that generated this section was: **data_processing.qmd**.